

Emergency Department Guidelines

Emergency Department

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Version: 1.0

Department: Emergency Department

Status: Active

1. Purpose & Scope

Defines the operating principles, scope of services, and patient flow for the Shifa Hospital Emergency Department (ED), which operates 24 hours a day, 7 days a week.

2. Scope of Services

- Resuscitation and stabilization of critically ill or injured patients
- Trauma and accident care
- Acute medical, surgical, pediatric, and obstetric emergencies
- Rapid diagnostic support (point-of-care lab, portable imaging)
- Short-stay observation for patients pending admission or discharge decision

3. Patient Arrival & Flow

- Step 1: Patient arrives via ambulance or walk-in and is received at the ED entrance
- Step 2: Immediate visual assessment by the triage nurse (see Triage Protocol ER-GL-02)
- Step 3: Patient is directed to resuscitation, acute, or minor-treatment area based on triage level
- Step 4: Attending physician performs assessment and orders investigations/treatment
- Step 5: Disposition decision — discharge, admit, transfer, or observe

4. Code Protocols (Overview)

- Code Blue — Cardiac or respiratory arrest, resuscitation team activated immediately
- Code Red — Fire emergency, evacuation protocol initiated
- Code Trauma — Multi-system trauma alert, trauma team paged
- Code Pink — Infant/child abduction or pediatric emergency alert

5. Documentation Requirements

Every ED encounter must have a completed triage record, physician assessment note, and disposition summary in the Hospital Management System before the patient leaves the department.

6. Family & Visitor Policy

One attendant is permitted at the bedside in the acute care area; resuscitation areas remain restricted to clinical staff only unless the treating physician grants an exception.